PLAYBOOK

AI models up to 17x cheaper. Check this first.

Open-weight models like DeepSeek are listed far below Claude per token. Here is what to test before you move any work across.

SWIPE ››



01 / 06

The price gap

Per million tokens, DeepSeek V4.1 Flash is listed at $0.15 in and $0.60 out off-peak. Claude Sonnet 5 is $2 and $10. Roughly 7 to 17 times cheaper, depending on the time of day.

START WITH

Check each provider's own pricing page today. These rates move and sources disagree.



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What it means in pounds

On 5 million tokens in and 1 million out, about $2.70 against $20. Real money only at high volume, such as sorting every enquiry or summarising every call.

> START WITH
>
> **Estimate your monthly volume before you get excited about the saving.**



03 / 06

Cheap is not cheap per task

One benchmark found the cheapest model per solved task was not the top scorer. Retries and wrong answers eat the saving.

> START WITH
>
> **Measure cost per finished job on your own work, not per token.**



Where your data goes

DeepSeek's own policy says data is stored in China. A UK firm sending personal data through the API would likely be the exporter and needs a transfer risk assessment.

START WITH

Ask any provider where the servers are and whether prompts are kept or used for training.



Check the licence

Open-weight is not open source. Some licences limit commercial use or set revenue thresholds. We could not confirm DeepSeek Flash's licence from our sources.

START WITH

Read the licence on the model's own page before you build on it.



06 / 06

Test on safe jobs first

Drafts from public facts, price lists, product descriptions. Run ten real examples through both models, names removed, and score each one yourself out of five.

START WITH

Pick one routine job with no customer data and run the ten-example test this week.

Test it on safe work. Then decide.

We have not run a client workload on these models yet, so this is how we would approach it, not a verdict. Prices are tool costs and will change.

Which job in your business could you hand to a cheaper model tomorrow without a single customer name in the prompt?